GitHub Copilot Admin

Field Guide & Action Worksheet

Leadership • Finance • Security

Use this after the workshop to find the control, capture the evidence, and turn what you see into an answer you can take back.

Start with the stakeholder question

Stakeholder	Question	Where you look	What you bring back
Leadership	How do we constrain Copilot?	Agent governance, instructions/exclusions, cloud agent + automations, internet access	Current setting, scope, owner, recommendation
Finance	Where is Copilot spend coming from?	Billing overview, cost centers, budgets, included/paid usage controls	Org amount, financial owner, applicable limits, paid/stop behavior
Security	How are policies and access managed?	Access, policies, inherited controls, audit log	Who has access, what is enforced, who changed what and when

Before you start

[ ] Use an account with the enterprise, organization, and billing permissions required for the section you are reviewing.

[ ] Pick one organization (and one representative repository when needed) so your evidence stays consistent across the three inquiries.

[ ] Write down the date/time or billing period you reviewed. For audit log work, set an explicit date range instead of relying on whatever happens to be on screen.

[ ] Settings visible in GitHub can vary by plan, role, enterprise policy, and feature availability.

Takeaway goal

By the end, you should be able to give each stakeholder a short answer backed by the exact GitHub setting or billing record you reviewed.

Leadership: How do we constrain Copilot?

Use this page to find the major controls and note their enterprise, organization, or repository scope. Record any agent-specific configuration separately, then prepare a leadership-ready answer.

Use the right language

A constraint is not always a hard block. Custom instructions guide Copilot behavior and may not be followed identically every time. Treat policy settings, rulesets, repository access, content exclusions, and firewall controls as the stronger enforcement boundaries.

1 Agent governance + rulesets

Where to find it

- Enterprise > AI controls > Agents. Review the configured source of governance and agent availability.
- Enterprise custom agents can live in a designated .github-private repository. The Agents page can create a ruleset that protects agent profile files.
- Branch rulesets still apply to Copilot cloud agent just as they apply to human developers.

Governance source: _____

Agent-file ruleset: _____

Required checks / reviews: _____

2 Instructions + content exclusions

Where to find it

- Organization Settings > Copilot > Custom instructions.
- Organization Settings > Copilot > Content exclusion.
- Record what the instructions ask Copilot to do and which repositories or paths are excluded. Verify support for the Copilot surface you care about.

Instructions in place: _____

Excluded content: _____

Scope / surface: _____

3 Cloud agent + automations

Where to find it

- Organization Settings > Copilot > Cloud agent.
- Review Repository access to see where the cloud agent can run.
- Review Allow automations. Enterprise policy can prevent an organization from overriding some settings.

Repository access: _____

Automations: _____

Enterprise override: _____

4 Internet access

Where to find it

- Organization Settings > Copilot > Internet access.
- Review firewall state, recommended allowlist, repository custom rules, and the organization custom allowlist.
- Organization settings can lock repository-level choices. Disabling the firewall expands outbound access and increases data-exfiltration risk.

Firewall: _____

Repo custom rules: _____

Allowed domains / URLs: _____

Leadership answer builder

Constraint	_____
Scope	_____
Owner	_____
Recommendation	_____

Official GitHub references (Leadership)

Agent governance and rulesets | Copilot policies for enterprises and organizations | Organization custom instructions | Content exclusion | Cloud agent and automations | Internet access / firewall

Finance: Where is Copilot spend coming from?

Follow the workshop flow in order. Capture the number, map it to an owner, then record every limit that can affect paid usage.

Prerequisites

[ ] Use an enterprise owner or billing manager account.
[ ] Confirm the demonstration enterprise has organization-level billing data, at least one cost center, and at least one relevant budget or included-usage control.

1 Check organization spend

Enterprise account > Billing & Licensing > Overview > Usage by organization > View all organization usage > add 'org:YOURORGNAME' in the filter. Select the organization and capture the displayed amount for the current billing period.

Organization	Billing period	Gross amount	Billable amount
_____	_____	_____	_____

If the view distinguishes gross and billable amounts, use the billable amount as the direct answer to Finance.

2 Review cost centers

Open Cost centers. Find the cost center associated with the selected organization or relevant resources. Review assigned organizations, repositories, users, and enterprise teams.

Cost center: _____
Financial owner / business unit: _____
Resources mapped to it: _____
[ ] If no cost center applies, record the cost as Enterprise Only.

3 Review budgets

Open Budgets and alerts. Identify every applicable enterprise, organization, cost-center, product, SKU, or user-level budget. Overlapping budgets may apply; the most restrictive applicable hard stop can block usage first.

Scope	Monthly amount	Current consumption	Alert recipients	Stop usage?

4 Review included and paid usage controls

Copilot licenses fund one shared enterprise AI-credit pool. Open the cost center to check its included-usage cap, based on assigned licenses. Confirm block vs. paid overage, plus the paid-usage policy and user-level budget.

Included-usage control: _____
At the limit, usage is: [ ] Blocked [ ] Paid usage permitted
Paid-usage policy: _____
Relevant user-level budget: _____

Finance-ready answer
For this billing period, _____ shows _____ billable (_____ gross). Costs map to _____. Applicable budgets/limits are _____. When included usage is reached, _____, subject to _____.

Security: How are policies and access managed?

Use the organization settings and audit log to separate three questions: who has access, what is allowed, and who changed it.

1 Review Copilot access

Organization > Settings > Copilot > Access.

[ ] Open the Filter dropdown to see available access views.
[ ] Open the Get usage report dropdown to review the report options available to admins.
[ ] Open the Copilot plan status dropdown and note whether access is Disabled, All members, or Selected members.

Current access state: _____
Who / what is included: _____
Usage report selected: _____

Workshop note: when All members is selected, the access-management list below does not determine who is included because all organization members receive access.

2 Review policy controls

Enterprise > AI controls > Copilot: review baseline; Organization > Settings > Copilot > Policies: check inherited/delegated.

Area	Current setting	Inherited / enforced by	Follow-up
Features			
Clients			
Agents			
MCP			
Preview / other			

3 Verify policy and admin changes in the audit log

Organization > Settings > Logs (under Archive) > Audit log. Set an explicit review period first.

Review period created: _____
Workshop example: created:2026-10-01..2026-10-29

Audit search	What it answers	What to record
action:copilot	Copilot policy and settings changes	Actor, action, timestamp
action:business	Enterprise administrator changes	Actor, role/admin change, timestamp
action:org	Organization administrator changes	Actor, role/admin change, timestamp
action:copilot.cfb_seat_assignment_created	New Copilot seat grants	Actor, affected user, timestamp
action:copilot.cfb_seat_cancelled	Copilot seat removals	Actor, affected user, timestamp
action:team	Team membership changes that may drive seat assignment	Actor, affected user/team, timestamp

Security-ready answer

Copilot access is _____. Key policy controls are enforced by _____. During _____, _____ changed _____ at _____. _____ gained/lost access through _____.

Your Copilot admin action plan

Turn the workshop into three concrete follow-ups. Keep the scope narrow enough that each item can be owned and completed.

CONSTRAINTS

What guardrail or constraint do you need to review?

Action	Owner	Next step	Target date

Evidence / link: _____

SPEND

What do you need to review about cost ownership?

Action	Owner	Next step	Target date

Evidence / link: _____

CONTROL

What policy or access setting do you need?

Action	Owner	Next step	Target date

Evidence / link: _____

Decision-ready summary

Leadership: We constrain Copilot by _____
Finance: Copilot spend is owned by _____
Security: Copilot access and policies are controlled by _____

Use this after the workshop

Revisit the three answer boxes after you make changes. The goal is not just to find a setting once; it is to be able to explain what is configured, who owns it, and what evidence supports your answer.